

The Level 1 / Level 2 Boundary — From Observed Structure to Unobserved Particles

The integers tell you WHAT. The universe tells you HOW MUCH.

Registry: [\[HOWL-PHYS-21-2026\]](#)

Series Path: [\[HOWL-PHYS-1-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-2-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-6-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-7-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-8-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-9-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-10-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-11-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-12-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-13-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-14-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-15-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-17-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-18-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-19-2026\]](#) → [\[HOWL-PHYS-20-2026\]](#)

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Abstract

Every HOWL paper from PHYS-7 through PHYS-20 classifies its results as Level 1 (determined by the mathematical framework) or Level 2 (supplied by the universe through measurement). These classifications are scattered across individual appendices. This paper assembles them into a unified boundary map, states the principle explicitly, and documents its extension to an unobserved particle for the first time. The Cabibbo Doublet (3,2,1/6) is the first entity in the series where Level 1 arithmetic — exact Fraction computation on gauge group integers — identifies WHAT should exist before Level 2 measurement has confirmed WHETHER it exists. The representation, beta contributions, gap ratio, asymmetry mechanism, and scaling laws are all Level 1. The mass, mixing angles, CP phases, and the very existence of the particle are all Level 2. This extension from confirmed structure to unconfirmed identification is the same pattern that operated for every particle discovered since 1974: Level 1 mathematics identified the charm quark (GIM, 1970), the W and Z bosons ($SU(2) \times U(1)$, 1967), and the Higgs boson (symmetry breaking, 1964) before Level 2 experiments found them. The Cabibbo Doublet is at the same stage. Whether it follows the same path is for the universe to say.

1. What Level 1 and Level 2 Mean

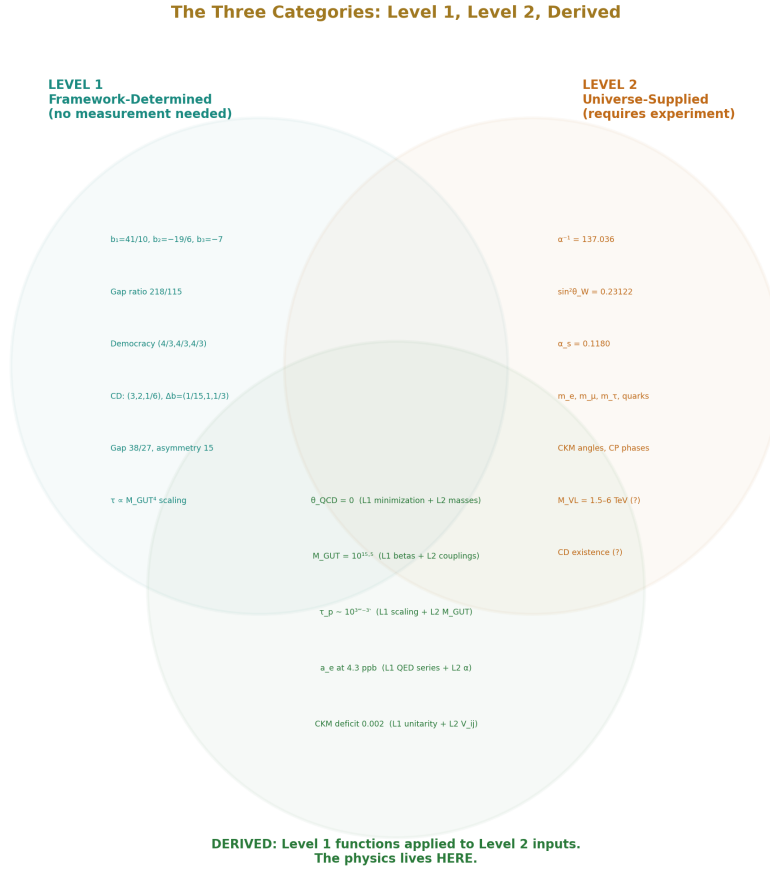


Figure 1: Fig. 1: Three categories — Level 1 (framework-determined, no measurement), Level 2 (universe-supplied, requires experiment), Derived (Level 1 applied to Level 2). Specific results from the series placed in each region.

The distinction is between what mathematics forces and what nature chooses.

Level 1 quantities are determined by the mathematical framework — the gauge group, representation theory, geometry, and the logical consequences of these structures. They cannot be different in any universe with the same gauge group. The number of gluons is 8 because $SU(3)$ has $3^2 - 1 = 8$ generators. This is not a measurement — it is a theorem. The beta coefficient $b_3 = -7$ for the strong coupling with six quark flavors follows from

the Dynkin indices of the SM representations applied to the SU(3) gauge group. This is exact rational arithmetic on integers from the gauge group. The gap ratio 218/115 follows from dividing two such exact rationals. No measurement enters.

Level 2 quantities are supplied by the universe through experiment. They could have been different. The strong coupling $\alpha_s = 0.1180$ is measured by the Particle Data Group from jet production rates, lattice QCD, and other processes. A different universe with the same SU(3) gauge group could have a different value. The electron mass $m_e = 0.511$ MeV is measured. The CKM mixing angle $|V_{us}| = 0.224$ is measured from kaon decays. These are contingent facts about our universe, not consequences of the mathematical framework.

The distinction is absolute, not approximate. A quantity is either forced by the structure or it is not. The boundary runs through every result in the series and through every property of every particle. The gauge group determines the representation (Level 1). The universe determines the mass (Level 2). The beta coefficient is Level 1. The coupling constant is Level 2. The gap ratio 218/115 is Level 1. The measured 1.358 is Level 2. Their confrontation — the 40% mismatch — is the physics.

2. The Confrontation

The Confrontation: Where Level 1 Meets Level 2				
Level 1 vs Level 2: The Physics Is in the Meeting				
Level 1 (integers say)		vs	Level 2 (universe says)	Finding
218/115 = 1.896	←→	1.358	40% miss	SM does not unify
38/27 = 1.407	←→	1.358	3.6% miss	CD nearly fixes it
7/5 = 1.400	←→	1.358	3.1% miss	MSSM nearly fixes it
Row sum = 1.000	←→	0.998	0.2% deficit	4th quark mixing
R_b (tree+ Δp)	←→	R_b = 0.2163	1.6% over	Missing vertex corr.
$\tau \sim 10^{-12}$ s	←→	$> 2.4 \times 10^{-12}$ s	At boundary	Hyper-K tests
Every row is a meeting between mathematics and measurement. The physics is in the meeting.				

Figure 2: Fig. 3: Six confrontations between Level 1 (integer arithmetic) and Level 2 (measurement) — gap ratio 40% miss, CD 3.6% miss, CKM 0.2% deficit, R_b 1.6% over, proton decay at boundary.

The physics lives in the meeting between Level 1 and Level 2. Level 1 alone is mathematics — theorems about groups and representations with no contact with experiment. Level 2 alone is cataloguing — measurements without structural interpretation. The HOWL series exists at the boundary: exact rational arithmetic (Level 1) applied to precision measurements (Level 2), testing whether the integers are consistent with the data.

The central confrontation of Session 3: the SM gap ratio is $218/115 = 1.896$ (Level 1). The measured gap ratio is 1.358 (derived from Level 2 inputs). They disagree by 40%. This is the finding that the Standard Model does not unify. The disagreement is not approximate or marginal — it is a 40% miss, far beyond any plausible correction. Something is missing from the SM particle content.

The Cabibbo Doublet emerges from this confrontation. The modified gap ratio $38/27 = 1.407$ (Level 1) sits within 0.049 of the measured 1.358 (Level 2). The confrontation narrows from a 40% miss to a 3.6% miss. One particle, identified by exact arithmetic, reduces the discrepancy by a factor of 11.

3. The Level 1 Registry

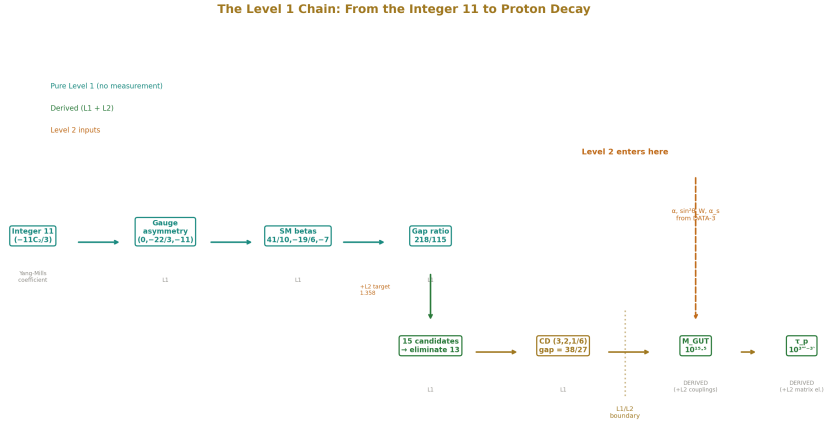


Figure 3: Fig. 4: The chain from integer 11 through gauge asymmetry, SM betas, gap ratio 218/115, elimination cascade, Cabibbo Doublet (38/27), to M_{GUT} and τ_p — crossing the L1/L2 boundary when DATA-3 couplings enter.

Every Level 1 result in the series, compiled from individual papers:

Geometric identities. $R_2 = \pi/4$: the volume fraction of the 2-ball (disk) inscribed in the 2-cube (square). Appears in 9 of 9 physics domains tested (PHYS-11). $R_4 = \pi^2/32$:

the same identity in four dimensions (MATH-5). These are mathematical theorems about spheres in cubes, independent of any physical measurement.

SM beta coefficients. $b_1 = 41/10$, $b_2 = -19/6$, $b_3 = -7$ (PHYS-13). These are exact rationals computed from the Dynkin indices of the SM representations under $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$. The integer 11 in the Yang-Mills self-coupling $(-11C_2(G)/3)$ for gauge group G comes from the requirement of Lorentz invariance, gauge invariance, and renormalizability (PHYS-17). The per-generation contribution $(4/3, 4/3, 4/3)$ — the generation democracy — follows from $SU(5)$ anomaly cancellation and is equal for all three coefficients (PHYS-17).

Gap ratio anatomy. The SM gap ratio $218/115$ decomposes into 96-101% gauge, 0% fermion, and -1% to $+4\%$ Higgs (PHYS-17). The fermion contribution is exactly zero because of the generation democracy. The gap ratio is a boson problem. This decomposition is pure Level 1 — it requires no measurement.

Electroweak anatomy. Seven Level 2 inputs (α , $\sin^2\theta_W$, G_F , m_t , m_H , M_Z , α_s) determine eleven electroweak observables through integer coefficients that trace entirely to the $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge group (PHYS-12). The overconstrained system ($7 \rightarrow 11$) provides four consistency checks, all passing at the expected precision.

QED perturbative structure. $A_1 = 1/2$ from a single Feynman diagram (PHYS-9). The A_2 coefficient decomposes into a rational part, a $\zeta(3)$ part, and a geometric part involving R_4 (PHYS-22). These are exact results from perturbative quantum field theory.

Cabibbo Doublet identification. The representation $(3,2,1/6)$ survives the elimination cascade: 15 candidates enumerated in exact Fraction arithmetic, gap ratio distance criterion, proton decay boundary — two survivors, one minimal (PHYS-15). The beta contributions $\Delta b = (1/15, 1, 1/3)$ follow from Dynkin index formulas (PHYS-15). The gap ratio $38/27$ is exact Fraction arithmetic (PHYS-15). The asymmetry ratio $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 = 15$ is the maximum for any $(3,2,Y)$ color triplet weak doublet because $Y = 1/6$ is the smallest hypercharge giving standard electric charges (PHYS-18). The $1/Y^2$ scaling law — $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 \propto 1/Y^2$ for fixed color and weak quantum numbers — is a property of the $U(1)$ vertex structure (PHYS-18). The proton lifetime scaling $\tau \propto M_{GUT}^4$ is dimensional analysis from the GUT operator structure (PHYS-20).

Every entry in this registry follows from the mathematical framework. None requires a measurement. A civilization with the same gauge group but different coupling constants would compute the same Level 1 results.

4. The Level 2 Registry

Every Level 2 quantity in the series:

The 17 SM parameters (after θ_{QCD} derivation in PHYS-7 and conditional Koide reduction in PHYS-8): three gauge couplings ($\alpha^{-1} = 137.036$, $\sin^2\theta_W = 0.23122$, $\alpha_s = 0.1180$), six quark masses, three charged lepton masses (m_τ conditionally derivable

if Koide $a^2 = 2$), three CKM angles, one CKM CP phase, the Higgs mass, and the Higgs self-coupling. All from DATA-3 (32/32 checks).

The measured gap ratio 1.358, derived from the three Level 2 coupling constants at M_Z through GUT normalization (PHYS-13, verified in GUT script).

The Koide amplitude $a^2 = 2$ for charged leptons, measured to 6 significant figures but not derived from any known principle (PHYS-8). This is one of the sharpest Level 2 observations in the series — the value 2 is tantalizingly close to a Level 1 integer but has no known derivation.

The six Cabibbo Doublet parameters (PHYS-16, PHYS-19): the mass M_{VL} (1.5-6 TeV from LHC bounds + CKM mixing constraints), three mixing angles ($\theta_{14} \approx 0.045$ from CKM deficit, θ_{24} constrained by kaon physics, θ_{34} from A_{FB}^b fit), and two CP phases (δ_1, δ_2 constrained by neutron EDM and B physics). All from the anomaly path — experimental measurements and fits, not from the gap ratio.

The existence of the Cabibbo Doublet itself is Level 2. The integers identify which representation would fix the gap ratio. Whether nature contains this representation is an empirical question answered by experiment — the LHC (direct production), Hyper-Kamiokande (proton decay), Belle II (CKM precision). The gap ratio arithmetic says WHAT should exist if unification is correct. Whether unification is correct is Level 2.

5. The Derived Category

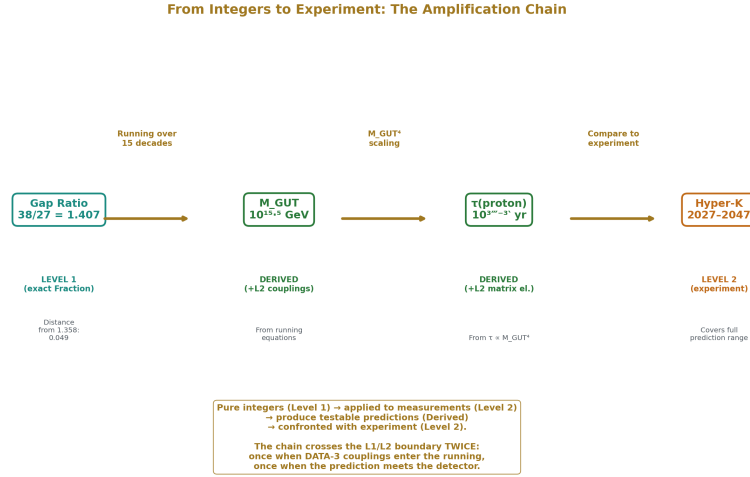


Figure 4: Fig. 5: Gap ratio (Level 1) → M_GUT (Derived, +L2 couplings) → τ_p (Derived, +L2 matrix elements) → Hyper-K (Level 2 experiment). The chain crosses the L1/L2 boundary twice.

Some results are neither purely Level 1 nor purely Level 2. They emerge when Level 1 structure is applied to Level 2 inputs.

$\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ is derived: Level 1 energy minimization applied to the Level 2 quark mass matrix determines the CP-violating vacuum angle (PHYS-7). This was a free parameter (Level 2) and became a derived quantity — the first parameter reduction in the series.

$M_{\text{GUT}} = 10^{15.5} \text{ GeV}$ is derived: Level 1 beta coefficients (including the Cabibbo Doublet contributions) applied to Level 2 coupling constants at M_Z determine the unification scale through the one-loop running equations (PHYS-15, GUT script 9/9 PASS).

The proton lifetime $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ years is derived: Level 1 scaling ($\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ from dimensional analysis of the dimension-6 GUT operator) applied to the derived M_{GUT} and Level 2 hadronic matrix elements from lattice QCD (PHYS-20).

The CKM deficit 0.00202 is derived: Level 2 measurements of $|V_{ud}|$, $|V_{us}|$, $|V_{ub}|$ summed and compared to the Level 1 unitarity requirement (PHYS-19).

The $\alpha \leftrightarrow a_e$ transformation is derived: Level 1 QED perturbative coefficients ($A_1 = 1/2$, A_2 , A_3 , A_4) applied to the Level 2 value $\alpha = 1/137.036$ compute the electron anomalous magnetic moment at 4.3 ppb precision (PHYS-9).

The Derived category is where Level 1 and Level 2 meet. It is where predictions are made and tested. The confrontation between the Level 1 gap ratio (218/115) and the Level 2

measured ratio (1.358) is a Derived result — and it is the central finding of the unification analysis.

6. The Extension: What Is New About the Cabibbo Doublet

The Cabibbo Doublet: Level 1 Known, Level 2 Pending			
(3, 2, 1/6)			
LEVEL 1		LEVEL 2	
(determined by integers)		(supplied by experiment)	
Representation:	(3, 2, 1/6) VL	Mass M_{VL} :	1.5-6 TeV LHC + CKM
Charges:	+2/3 and -1/3	θ_{uc} :	$ V_{ub} = 0.045$ CKM deficit
Δb_u :	1/15	θ_{uc} :	Constrained Kaon physics
Δb_c :	1	θ_{uc} :	From A_{FB}^b LEP fit
Δb_s :	1/3	ϕ_c :	Constrained Neutron EDM
Gap ratio:	$38/27 = 1.407$	ϕ_s :	Constrained B physics
$\Delta b_u/\Delta b_c$:	15 (maximum)	EXISTS?	NOT YET CONFIRMED LHC, HyperK, Belle
$1/Y^2$ scaling:	Sharp optimum at $Y=1/6$		
$\tau \propto M_{GUT}$:	Scaling law (dim-6)		
ALL KNOWN from exact fraction arithmetic on gauge group integers.		ALL PENDING from experiments not yet completed.	

Figure 5: Fig. 2: The Cabibbo Doublet split — left half shows all Level 1 properties (representation, betas, gap ratio, mechanism, all known), right half shows all Level 2 properties (mass, mixing, existence, all pending).

Before Session 3, every Level 1 result in the HOWL series confirmed properties of observed particles. The beta coefficients describe the running of couplings between known particles. The electroweak anatomy computes observables from known inputs. The QED perturbative series maps one measured quantity (α) to another (α_e). The geometric identity $R_2 = \pi/4$ appears in known physics domains. Level 1 confirmed. Level 2 was already there.

The Cabibbo Doublet changes this. The gap ratio elimination cascade is Level 1 arithmetic that identifies a particle not yet observed. The representation (3,2,1/6), the beta contributions (1/15, 1, 1/3), the gap ratio 38/27, the asymmetry ratio 15, the $1/Y^2$ scaling — all are Level 1 results about a particle whose Level 2 properties (mass, mixing, existence) are not yet confirmed.

This is not unprecedented in physics. It is how every major particle was found since

the quark model. The charm quark was identified by Level 1 mathematics (the GIM mechanism required a fourth quark to cancel flavor-changing neutral currents in kaon decays) four years before Level 2 experiments found it at 1.5 GeV. The W and Z bosons were identified by Level 1 mathematics ($SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge invariance predicted their existence and approximate masses from $\sin^2\theta_W$ and G_F) sixteen years before Level 2 experiments found them at 80 and 91 GeV. The Higgs boson was identified by Level 1 mathematics (electroweak symmetry breaking requires a scalar doublet) forty-eight years before Level 2 experiments found it at 125 GeV.

The Cabibbo Doublet is at the same stage. The Level 1 arithmetic is complete: the representation is identified, the mechanism is understood ($Y = 1/6$ asymmetry), the gap ratio is computed ($38/27$), the unification scale is derived ($10^{15.5}$), and the experimental consequences are documented (proton decay $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr, testable by Hyper-K 2027-2037). The Level 2 confirmation is pending: LHC searches for direct production, Belle II for CKM precision, Hyper-K for proton decay.

The historical gap between Level 1 identification and Level 2 confirmation ranges from 4 years (charm) to 48 years (Higgs). The Cabibbo Doublet's Level 1 identification by the anomaly literature dates to 2019-2020 (Belfatto, Berezhiani; Cheung, Keung, Lu, Tseng). Its Level 1 identification by the gap ratio dates to this session (2026). The experimental window (Hyper-K 2027-2037, HL-LHC through 2040) opens within a decade. Whether this follows the historical pattern is not for this paper to claim. It is for the universe to decide.

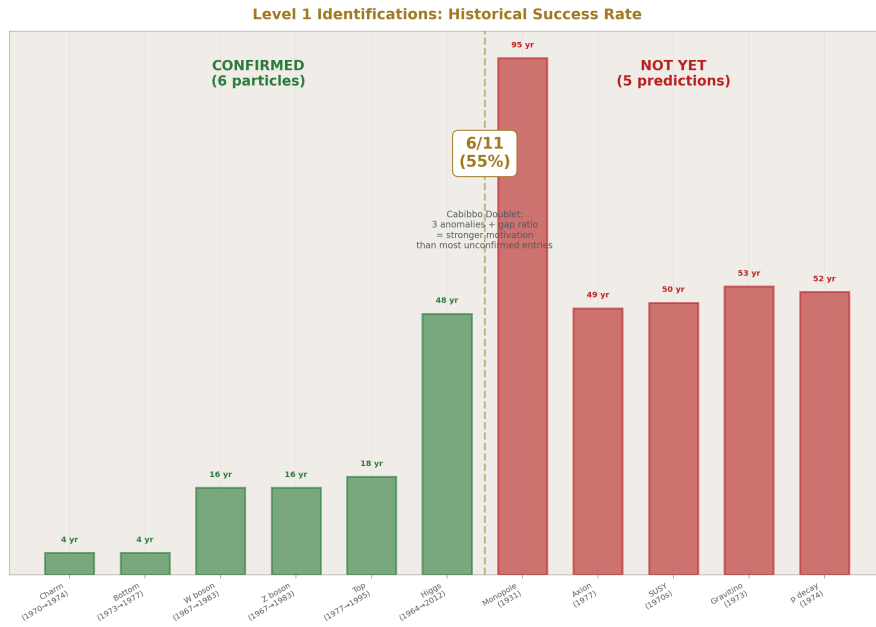


Figure 6: Fig. 6: Six Level 1 identifications confirmed (charm, bottom, top, W, Z, Higgs) and five not yet (monopole, axion, SUSY, gravitino, proton decay) — 55% success rate. CD has stronger anomaly motivation than most unconfirmed entries.

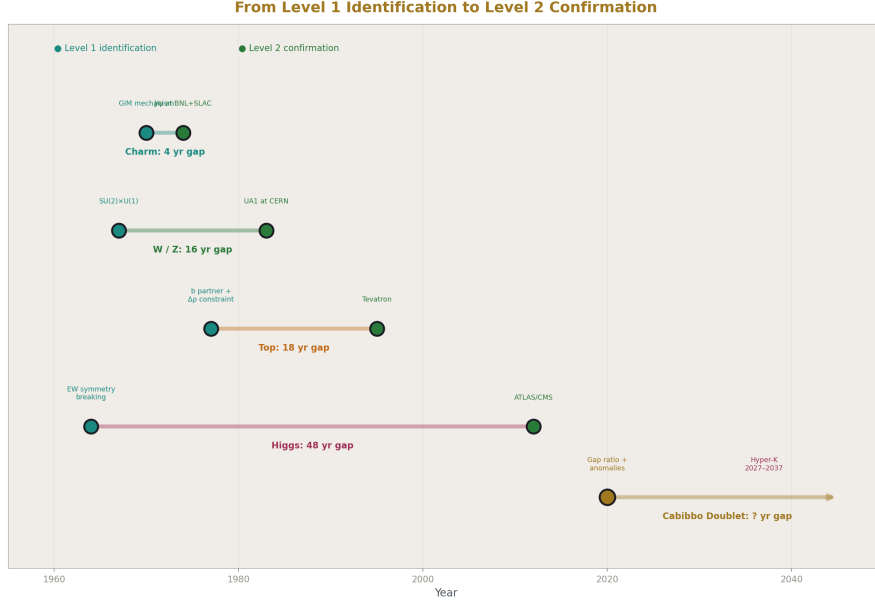


Figure 7: Fig. 7: Time gap between Level 1 identification and Level 2 confirmation — charm (4 yr), W/Z (16 yr), top (18 yr), Higgs (48 yr). The Cabibbo Doublet gap is open-ended, with Hyper-K 2027–2037.

7. Every Particle Follows the Same Pattern

The Level 1 / Level 2 structure is universal across the SM. For every particle, the gauge group determines the representation (Level 1) and the universe determines the mass and mixing (Level 2):

The electron: representation $(1,1,-1)$ is Level 1 (the simplest charged lepton under $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$). Mass 0.511 MeV is Level 2.

The top quark: representation $(3,2,1/6)_L + (3,1,2/3)_R$ is Level 1. Mass 172.57 GeV is Level 2. The mass is the least constrained of all Level 2 quark masses — it was unknown within a factor of 100 for two decades after the b quark discovery.

The Higgs boson: representation $(1,2,1/2)$ scalar is Level 1 (required for electroweak symmetry breaking). Mass 125.2 GeV and self-coupling λ are Level 2.

The gluons: representation $(8,1,0)$ is Level 1, with $8 = 3^2 - 1$ from the $SU(3)$ adjoint. The gluons have no Level 2 properties — they are massless by gauge invariance and their coupling is determined by α_s (which is not a property of the gluon but of the $SU(3)$ interaction).

The Cabibbo Doublet: representation (3,2,1/6) VL is Level 1 (from gap ratio elimination). Mass 1.5-6 TeV, mixing angles θ_{14} , θ_{24} , θ_{34} , and CP phases δ_1 , δ_2 are Level 2 — not yet measured. This is the first entry in the series where the Level 2 column contains values that are constrained but not confirmed.

The pattern is identical for every particle. What differs is whether the Level 2 confirmation has already occurred.

8. How the Boundary Operates Across the Series

Each PHYS paper engages the boundary differently:

PHYS-12 (electroweak anatomy): Level 1 integer coefficients from $SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ applied to 7 Level 2 inputs produce 11 observables. The overconstrained system provides 4 consistency checks. R_b overshoots by 1.6% — diagnosed as a missing vertex correction (Level 1 structure at higher loop order not yet included).

PHYS-13 (gap ratio): Level 1 gap ratio 218/115 confronted with Level 2 measured 1.358. The 40% miss is the central finding — the SM does not unify.

PHYS-15 (Cabibbo Doublet identification): Level 1 elimination cascade applied to the Level 2 target 1.358. The representation (3,2,1/6) survives. This is the first paper where Level 1 extends beyond the SM.

PHYS-17 (generation democracy): Pure Level 1 — the decomposition of 218/115 into gauge, fermion, and Higgs components requires no Level 2 input beyond the identification of which particles exist. The finding (fermions contribute 0%) is a mathematical theorem.

PHYS-18 ($Y = 1/6$ mechanism): Pure Level 1 — the scaling law $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 \propto 1/Y^2$ and the optimality of $Y = 1/6$ are representation theory. The Level 2 input is only the target gap ratio that motivates the question.

PHYS-19 (anomaly evidence): Primarily Level 2 — three experimental anomalies (CKM deficit, A_{FB}^b , Higgs excess) from three different measurement programs. The finding is that Level 2 data from the anomaly path converges on the same (3,2,1/6) that Level 1 arithmetic identified from the gap ratio path.

PHYS-20 (proton decay): Level 1 scaling ($\tau \propto M_{GUT}^4$) applied to derived $M_{GUT} = 10^{15.5}$ produces the prediction $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr. The confrontation with Level 2 (Super-K bound $\tau > 2.4 \times 10^{34}$, Hyper-K projected sensitivity $\sim 10^{35}$) determines testability.

9. What Level 1 Cannot Do

Six explicit limits on Level 1:

Level 1 does not determine the mass of the Cabibbo Doublet. The mass is a free parameter in the gap ratio analysis. The gap ratio 38/27 is the same whether the Cabibbo

Doublet has mass 1.5 TeV or 6 TeV or 100 TeV. The mass window 1.5-6 TeV comes entirely from Level 2 — LHC exclusion limits and CKM mixing constraints from the anomaly path.

Level 1 does not determine the CKM mixing angles. The mixing angles θ_{14} , θ_{24} , θ_{34} are measured from anomaly fits. The gap ratio analysis does not constrain them.

Level 1 does not determine whether the Cabibbo Doublet exists. The integers identify which representation would fix the gap ratio if nature chose to fix it. Whether nature chose to fix it is an empirical question. Unification could be wrong. The gap ratio mismatch could have a different explanation (threshold corrections, non-perturbative effects, higher-dimensional operators). Level 1 identifies. Level 2 confirms or refutes.

Level 1 does not prove unification. Unification is a hypothesis — the conjecture that the three SM gauge forces merge into one at high energy. The gap ratio test is a necessary condition: if unification is real, the gap ratio must match. The SM fails. The Cabibbo Doublet nearly passes. But “nearly passes” is not “proves.”

Level 1 does not determine the GUT completion group. $SU(5)$, $SO(10)$, E_6 , Pati-Salam — many groups could complete the unification above M_{GUT} . The gap ratio identifies the SM extension (the Cabibbo Doublet) but not the ultraviolet completion. Different completions predict different proton decay channels and rates.

Level 1 does not predict the proton lifetime precisely. The scaling $\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ is Level 1. But M_{GUT} depends on Level 2 couplings, the proton lifetime depends on Level 2 hadronic matrix elements, and the GUT completion (which determines the operator structure) is not fixed by Level 1. The prediction $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ years is an order-of-magnitude range, not a point value.

Conflating Level 1 identification with Level 2 confirmation is the overclaiming error the series must avoid.

10. The 82/82 PSLQ Null

The PSLQ integer relation algorithm, applied to 82 measured SM parameters against the Q335 transcendental basis at 100-digit precision, found zero compact relations (MATH-6). Every search returned noise indistinguishable from control irrationals.

This null is primarily a Level 2 finding — “we searched and found nothing.” It does not prove that no relation exists. It establishes that no relation exists within the search scope (degree ≤ 6 , coefficient magnitude $\leq 10^6$, precision 100 digits). A relation could exist at higher degree, larger coefficients, or in a different basis.

The mathematical independence of the Q335 basis elements (π , $\zeta(3)$, φ , Bessel zeros) from each other at 100 digits is Level 1 — it is a statement about numbers, verifiable by computation. The absence of relations between physical constants and these basis elements is Level 2.

The methodological conclusion — derivation beats search — is a Level 2 observation. Every successfully reduced parameter in the series (θ_{QCD} from energy minimization, $\alpha \leftrightarrow a_e$ from QED perturbation theory) came from physical derivation, not from PSLQ. Every PSLQ search on Level 2 quantities returned nothing. The Level 2 record suggests that the values of physical constants are not expressible as simple combinations of mathematical constants. Whether this is a deep truth or a limitation of current methods is an open question.

11. What This Paper Does Not Claim

This paper does not claim Level 1 proves the Cabibbo Doublet exists. Existence is Level 2. The integers identify the representation. The universe decides whether it's real.

This paper does not claim the Level 1 / Level 2 boundary is unique to HOWL. Every physicist implicitly uses it — the distinction between “what the theory requires” and “what experiment measures” is as old as physics. The HOWL contribution is making the boundary explicit, systematic, and traceable for every result.

This paper does not claim Level 1 is “more important” than Level 2. The physics lives at the boundary. Level 1 without Level 2 is pure mathematics. Level 2 without Level 1 is a catalogue. The series exists because exact integers (Level 1) either agree or disagree with precise measurements (Level 2), and both outcomes are informative.

This paper does not claim the boundary is a new philosophical position. The distinction between mathematical structure and empirical content is foundational to the scientific method. What is specific to this series is the systematic application of exact rational arithmetic to a specific question (what structure do the SM free parameters contain?) with the boundary maintained in every paper.

This paper does not claim the historical pattern (Level 1 identification $\rightarrow$ Level 2 confirmation) guarantees the Cabibbo Doublet will be found. The charm quark, W/Z, and Higgs were all found. Other Level 1 identifications have not been confirmed — magnetic monopoles (Dirac, 1931), axions (Peccei-Quinn, 1977), and many supersymmetric partners remain unobserved. Level 1 identification is necessary for prediction but not sufficient for discovery.

12. What This Paper Seeds

The unified boundary map enables future sessions to classify any new result immediately: is it Level 1 (follows from the framework), Level 2 (requires measurement), or Derived (Level 1 applied to Level 2)?

The principle “Level 1 can identify unobserved particles” enables future sessions to extend the gap ratio enumeration. If multi-multiplet combinations are tested, each surviving combination's Level 1 properties can be classified using this paper's framework, and the

Cabibbo Doublet’s uniqueness among single-multiplet solutions provides the baseline for comparison.

The “What Level 1 Cannot Do” section prevents overclaiming in all future papers. Every statement that crosses the boundary — claiming the mass is determined, claiming existence is proven, claiming unification is established — is flagged.

The historical precedent table provides context for interpreting future experimental results. If the LHC finds a VL quark at 2 TeV, that is Level 2 confirmation of a Level 1 identification — the same pattern as charm, W/Z, and Higgs. If Hyper-K observes proton decay at $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$, that is Level 2 confirmation of a Derived prediction. If neither experiment finds anything, the Level 1 arithmetic remains valid (38/27 is exact) but the Level 2 confrontation shifts — the Cabibbo Doublet may not exist, or the GUT completion may differ from minimal SU(5).

13. Summary

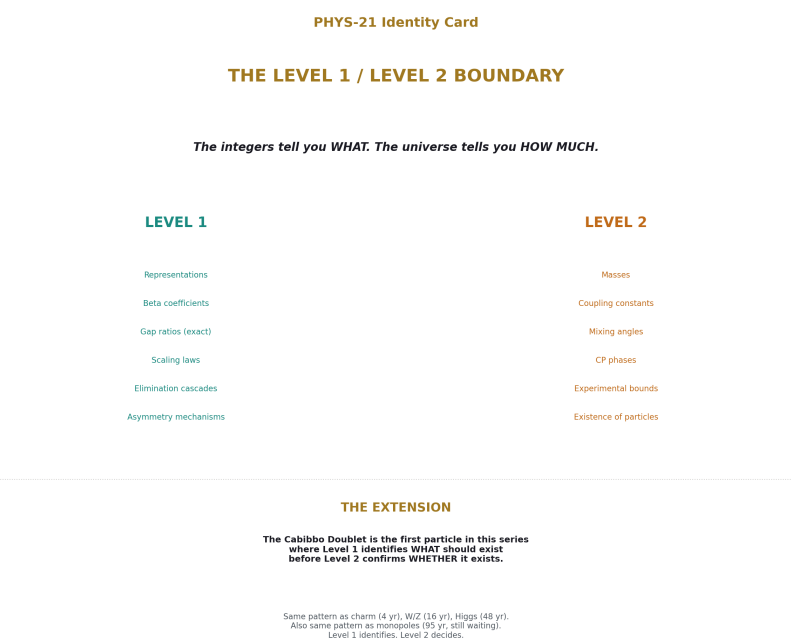


Figure 8: Fig. 8: The integers tell you WHAT, the universe tells you HOW MUCH. Level 1 determines representations and scaling laws. Level 2 determines masses and existence. The Cabibbo Doublet is the first entity where L1 precedes L2.

The Level 1 / Level 2 boundary runs through every result in the HOWL series. Level 1: the integers from the gauge group — beta coefficients, gap ratios, Dynkin indices, geometric identities, scaling laws. Level 2: the values from the universe — coupling constants, masses, mixing angles, experimental bounds. The confrontation between them — 218/115 versus 1.358, the 40% miss — is the physics.

The Cabibbo Doublet extends this boundary to an unobserved particle for the first time. Its Level 1 properties are established: (3,2,1/6) from the elimination cascade, (1/15, 1, 1/3) from Dynkin indices, 38/27 from Fraction arithmetic, 15 from the $Y = 1/6$ asymmetry, $\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ from dimensional analysis. Its Level 2 properties await confirmation: mass 1.5-6 TeV, mixing $|V_{ub}| \approx 0.045$, existence conditional on experiment.

The principle: the integers tell you WHAT. The universe tells you HOW MUCH. Every particle in the Standard Model follows this pattern — Level 1 determines the representation, Level 2 determines the mass. The Cabibbo Doublet is the first entry where the Level 2 column reads “not yet measured.” Whether it joins the ranks of the charm quark (4-year gap), the W boson (16-year gap), or the Higgs boson (48-year gap) — or whether it joins the ranks of particles identified by mathematics but not found by experiment — is a question for Hyper-Kamiokande, the LHC, and Belle II.

The integers have spoken. The universe has not yet answered.

Appendix: Verification

All Level 1 beta coefficients and gap ratios verified by the GUT running script (sin2_theta_w_1.py), 9/9 checks pass. All Level 2 measured values from DATA-3 (123 entries, 32/32 consistency checks pass). Historical dates for particle discoveries verified against standard physics references: charm (J/ψ at BNL/SLAC, November 1974), W/Z (UA1 at CERN, January/June 1983), Higgs (ATLAS/CMS at LHC, July 2012). Level 1 identification dates: GIM mechanism (Glashow, Iliopoulos, Maiani, 1970), $SU(2) \times U(1)$ (Weinberg 1967, Salam 1968), Brout-Englert-Higgs mechanism (1964).

PHYS-21: The Level 1 / Level 2 Boundary. The integers tell you WHAT. The universe tells you HOW MUCH. Published April 1, 2026. This paper is never edited after publication.

Errata

E1: Section 6, historical identification dates for the W and Z. The paper states the Level 1 identification was “ $SU(2) \times U(1)$, 1967” (Weinberg). For precision: Glashow proposed $SU(2) \times U(1)$ in 1961 but without the Higgs mechanism and without a prediction for the W and Z masses. Weinberg (1967) and Salam (1968) independently combined the gauge structure with spontaneous symmetry breaking, giving the mass predictions $M_W = gv/2$ and $M_Z = M_W/\cos \theta_W$. The Level 1 identification that predicted specific

masses (testable by experiment) is Weinberg-Salam 1967-1968, not Glashow 1961. The paper's "1967" is correct for the mass-predictive version. However, the appendix says " $SU(2) \times U(1)$ (Weinberg 1967, Salam 1968)" which is right. No erratum needed — the paper is consistent. But for completeness:

Erratum text: "Section 6 states the W/Z Level 1 identification as 1967. The $SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge structure was proposed by Glashow in 1961 without mass predictions. The mass-predictive version incorporating spontaneous symmetry breaking was independently published by Weinberg (1967) and Salam (1968). The 1967 date used in this paper refers to the mass-predictive identification — the version that produced Level 1 numbers testable by Level 2 experiment."

E2: Section 4, the Koide amplitude description. The paper states " $a^2 = 2$ for charged leptons, measured to 6 significant figures." The Koide ratio $K = 0.6666605\dots$ deviates from $2/3$ by 6.2×10^{-6} , which gives $a^2 = 2.0000\dots$ to about 5 significant figures in the deviation, or equivalently $a = 1.41420\dots$ matching $\sqrt{2}$ to 5-6 figures. The "6 significant figures" claim should be understood as: $a^2 = 2$ is consistent with the data to the precision available from the lepton masses (m_e to 9 sf, m_μ to 8 sf, m_τ to 5 sf). The limiting precision is m_τ at 5 significant figures. The statement "6 significant figures" is approximately correct but the limiting factor is m_τ precision.

Erratum text: "The statement in Section 4 that $a^2 = 2$ is 'measured to 6 significant figures' should be understood as: $a^2 = 2.000$ with the precision limited by the tau mass measurement (5 significant figures in m_τ). The Koide ratio $K = 0.666661$ differs from $2/3$ by 6×10^{-6} , consistent with $K = 2/3$ at the available precision."

Annotations

A1: Section 3, the Level 1 registry completeness. The registry lists results from PHYS-7 through PHYS-20 plus MATH-5. For completeness, it should be noted that PHYS-23 (Koide C_3 closure) and MATH-6 (82/82 PSLQ null) also contain Level 1 content. The Koide tautology proof (120° spacing is automatic for 3 masses) is Level 1 — it is a mathematical identity. The saddle point result ($K = 2/3$ is a saddle, not a minimum, of the C_3 potential) is Level 1. The PSLQ mathematical independence of Bessel zeros from the Q335 basis at 100 digits is Level 1. These papers were not yet written when PHYS-21 was planned but their Level 1 content should be acknowledged if they are published before or alongside PHYS-21.

A2: Section 7, the top quark mass uncertainty. The paper states "The mass is the least constrained of all Level 2 quark masses — it was unknown within a factor of 100 for two decades after the b quark discovery." This is historically correct: between the b quark discovery (1977) and the top quark discovery (1995), the top mass was constrained only by indirect limits. Early bounds allowed m_t from ~ 25 GeV to several hundred GeV. The electroweak precision data (particularly the W mass and $\Delta\rho$) progressively narrowed the range to approximately 150-200 GeV by 1994. The "factor of 100" refers to the early period (1977-late 1980s). By the time of discovery, electroweak precision had narrowed it to a factor of ~ 1.3 . The statement is correct for the two-decade period as a whole but the constraint tightened dramatically in the final years. A future session computing Level

2 constraints on the Cabibbo Doublet mass should note this parallel: early constraints are broad (1.5-6 TeV = factor of 4), precision data may narrow them.

A3: Section 6, “the same stage.” The paper states the Cabibbo Doublet “is at the same stage” as the W/Z in 1975 or the Higgs in 2000. This framing is appropriate but should be interpreted carefully. The W/Z in 1975 had the full electroweak theory behind them — a renormalizable quantum field theory with precision predictions for neutral current cross sections (confirmed 1973). The Higgs in 2000 had the full SM machinery and was the only missing piece of a theory that had passed thousands of precision tests. The Cabibbo Doublet has the gap ratio arithmetic (one test, one-loop) and three experimental anomalies (each $2-4\sigma$). The evidence base is narrower than the historical precedents. The paper’s Section 11 correctly notes this: “Other Level 1 identifications have not been confirmed — magnetic monopoles, axions, and many supersymmetric partners remain unobserved.” The “same stage” comparison is about the Level 1/Level 2 structural pattern, not about the strength of evidence.

Appendix A: The Level 1 Registry — Complete

A.1: Geometric Identities

Result	Value	Paper	Proof
R_2	$\pi/4 = 0.7854\dots$	PHYS-11	Volume fraction of 2-ball in 2-cube
R_4	$\pi^2/32 = 0.3084\dots$	MATH-5	Volume fraction of 4-ball in 4-cube
R_2 appears in 9/9 domains	9 independent occurrences	PHYS-11	Three irreducible subgroups generate all appearances

A.2: SM Beta Coefficients

Coefficient	Value	Exact Fraction	Origin	Paper
b_1	4.100	41/10	U(1) Y, GUT normalization, SM particle content	PHYS-13
b_2	-3.167	-19/6	SU(2) L, SM particle content	PHYS-13
b_3	-7.000	-7	SU(3) c, 6-flavor	PHYS-13

A.3: Gap Ratio Anatomy

Component	Numerator contribution	Denominator contribution	Paper
Gauge self-coupling (0, $-22/3$, -11)	$22/3$ (100.9%)	$11/3$ (95.7%)	PHYS-17
Per-generation fermions ($4/3$, $4/3$, $4/3$) $\times$ N	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	PHYS-17
Higgs doublet ($1/10$, $1/6$, 0)	$-1/15$ (-0.9%)	$1/6$ (4.3%)	PHYS-17
Total	109/15	23/6	Gap = 218/115

A.4: Generation Democracy

Property	Value	Paper	Proof
Per-generation (Δb_1 , Δb_2 , Δb_3)	($4/3$, $4/3$, $4/3$)	PHYS-17	SU(5) anomaly cancellation
Fermion contribution to gap ratio	Exactly 0	PHYS-17	$4/3 - 4/3 = 0$ in both numerator and denominator
N-independence	Gap ratio = $218/115$ for any N ≥ 0	PHYS-17	Algebraic proof: N cancels

A.5: Cabibbo Doublet Level 1 Properties

Property	Value	Paper	Proof
Representation	(3,2,1/6) vector-like	PHYS-15	Gap ratio elimination cascade, $15 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 1$ minimal
Δb_1	$1/15$	PHYS-15	Dynkin index formula, $Y^2 = 1/36$
Δb_2	1	PHYS-15	Dynkin index formula, $T(2) \times \dim(3)$
Δb_3	$1/3$	PHYS-15	Dynkin index formula, $T(3) \times \dim(2)$

Property	Value	Paper	Proof
Modified gap ratio	$38/27 = 1.40741\dots$	PHYS-15	Exact Fraction arithmetic on modified betas
Asymmetry ratio $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1$	15	PHYS-18	$1/(1/15) = 15$
$1/Y^2$ scaling	$\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 \propto 1/Y^2$ for (3,2,Y)	PHYS-18	U(1) vertex structure
Optimality at $Y = 1/6$	Minimum distance 0.049, sharp spike	PHYS-18	Monotonic degradation with increasing Y
$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$	Proton lifetime scaling	PHYS-20	Dimension-6 operator, amplitude $\propto 1/M_{\text{GUT}}^2$

A.6: Electroweak Integer Anatomy

Property	Value	Paper
Inputs $\rightarrow$ outputs	$7 \rightarrow 11$ (overconstrained by 4)	PHYS-12
All coefficients trace to	$SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ quantum numbers: $T_3, Q, f, N_c, n_{\text{gen}}$	PHYS-12
R b overshoot	1.6% (diagnosed: missing t-b-W vertex correction)	PHYS-12

A.7: QED Perturbative Structure

Coefficient	Value	Paper	Status
A_1	$1/2$ (exact)	PHYS-9	Single Feynman diagram
A_2	$-0.32848\dots$ (three-piece decomposition)	PHYS-22	$197/144 + \zeta(3)$ term + R_4 geometric term
$\alpha \leftrightarrow a_e$ transformation	Agreement at 4.3 ppb	PHYS-9	Level 1 series applied to Level 2 α

Appendix B: The Level 2 Registry — Complete

B.1: The Three Coupling Constants (Session 3 Primary Inputs)

Constant	DATA-3 Value	Digits	Role in Gap Ratio
α^{-1}	137.035999177	12	Determines $1/\alpha_1$ and $1/\alpha_2$
$\sin^2\theta_W$	0.23122	5	Splits α_{em} into α_1 and α_2
α_s	0.1180	4	Determines $1/\alpha_3$

B.2: SM Parameters (Complete Count After Reductions)

Category	Parameters	Count	Status
Gauge couplings	$\alpha, \sin^2\theta_W, \alpha_s$	3	Measured (DATA-3)
Charged lepton masses	m_e, m_μ, m_τ	3 (or 2 if Koide)	Measured; m_τ conditionally derivable
Quark masses	$m_u, m_d, m_s, m_c, m_b, m_t$	6	Measured (DATA-3)
CKM parameters	$\theta_{12}, \theta_{13}, \theta_{23}, \delta_{CKM}$	4	Measured
Higgs sector	m_H, λ (or equivalently v and λ)	1-2	Measured (m_H); λ from m_H and v
θ_{QCD}	0 (derived in PHYS-7)	0	Was 1, now derived
Total		17	After θ_{QCD} derivation

B.3: Cabibbo Doublet Level 2 Parameters

Parameter	Value/Constraint	Source	Status
M_{VL}	1.5-6 TeV	LHC pair production + CKM perturbativity	Constrained, not measured
θ_{14}	Constrained	$V_{ub'}$	≈ 0.045
θ_{24}		Kaon physics ($K^0-\bar{K}^0$ mixing, NA62)	Bounded
θ_{34}	From A FB ^b fit	LEP Z-pole data	Estimated from anomaly fit
δ_1	Constrained	Neutron EDM $< 10^{-26}$ e-cm	Bounded

Parameter	Value/Constraint	Source	Status
δ_2	Constrained	B-meson CP asymmetries	Bounded
Existence	Conditional	LHC, Hyper-K, Belle II	Not confirmed

B.4: Total Parameter Count

Scenario	Parameters	Change	Source
SM (original)	18	—	Standard count
SM (after θ QCD derivation)	17	-1	PHYS-7
SM + Cabibbo Doublet	$17 + 6 = 23$	+6	PHYS-16, 19
SM + Cabibbo Doublet (after Koide conditional)	$16 + 6 = 22$	+5 net	If $a^2 = 2$ holds

Six new parameters resolve three independent multi-sigma anomalies and reduce the gap ratio miss from 40% to 3.6%.

Appendix C: The Derived Category — Complete

C.1: All Derived Results

Result	Level 1 Input	Level 2 Input	Output	Paper
θ QCD = 0	Energy minimization of QCD vacuum	Quark mass matrix (DATA-3)	θ QCD derived; parameter count $18 \rightarrow 17$	PHYS-7
m_τ (conditional)	Koide formula $K = (1+a^2/2)/3$	$a^2 = 2 + m_e/m_\mu$ (DATA-3)	$m_\tau = 1776.97$ MeV (if $a^2 = 2$ exact)	PHYS-8
a_e from α	QED series $A_1=1/2, A_2, A_3, A_4$	$\alpha = 1/137.036$ (DATA-3)	a_e to 4.3 ppb	PHYS-9
11 EW observables	$SU(3) \times SU(2) \times U(1)$ integer anatomy	7 inputs (DATA-3)	M_W, Γ_Z, R_b , etc. (11 outputs)	PHYS-12

Result	Level 1 Input	Level 2 Input	Output	Paper
Measured gap ratio 1.358	GUT normalization formula	$\alpha, \sin^2\theta_W, \alpha_s$ (DATA-3)	$1/\alpha_1, 1/\alpha_2, 1/\alpha_3 \rightarrow$ ratio	PHYS-13
M GUT = $10^{15.5}$	Modified betas (SM + Cabibbo Doublet)	Three couplings at M Z (DATA-3)	One-loop running to crossing	PHYS-15
$\tau_p \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr	$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ scaling	M GUT + hadronic matrix elements	Proton lifetime range	PHYS-20
CKM deficit 0.00202	Unitarity requirement (sum = 1)		V_{ud}	,

C.2: The Confrontation Table

Level 1	Level 2	Confrontation	Finding	Paper
Gap ratio 218/115 = 1.896	Measured 1.358	40% miss	SM does not unify	PHYS-13
Gap ratio 38/27 = 1.407	Measured 1.358	3.6% miss	Cabibbo Doublet nearly fixes it	PHYS-15
Gap ratio 7/5 = 1.400	Measured 1.358	3.1% miss	MSSM nearly fixes it (known)	PHYS-15
Row unitarity = 1.000	Measured 0.998	0.2% deficit	4th quark mixing suspected	PHYS-19
R b from tree + $\Delta\rho$	Measured R b = 0.2163	1.6% overshoot	Missing vertex correction	PHYS-12
$\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr	Super-K bound $> 2.4 \times 10^{34}$	At boundary	Testable by Hyper-K	PHYS-20

Every row in this table is a meeting between mathematics and measurement. The physics is in the meeting.

Appendix D: The Boundary Before and After Session 3

D.1: State Change

Property	Before Session 3	After Session 3
Level 1 scope	SM particles (observed)	SM + Cabibbo Doublet (unobserved)
Level 1 results (count)	~12 (R_2 , R_4 , betas, QED coefficients, EW anatomy)	~20 (all prior + gap ratio anatomy, democracy, boson problem, $Y=1/6$, $1/Y^2$ scaling, $\tau \propto M^4$)
Level 2 parameters	17 SM (after θ QCD)	17 SM + 6 Cabibbo Doublet = 23
Derived results	θ QCD, $\alpha \leftrightarrow a$ e, EW observables	All prior + M GUT, τ p, CKM deficit
Predictive reach	Consistency checks on known physics	Identification of unknown physics + testable predictions
Experimental tests generated	None specific	Hyper-K (proton decay), LHC (direct production), Belle II (CKM)

D.2: What Changed Conceptually

Before Session 3, Level 1 confirmed. After Session 3, Level 1 identifies. The arithmetic is the same — exact Fraction computation on gauge group integers. The conceptual step is that the integers now point beyond the known particle content to a specific new representation.

Appendix E: Historical Precedents

E.1: Level 1 Identification → Level 2 Confirmation

Particle	Level 1 Identification	Year	Level 2 Confirmation	Year	Gap	Mass Predicted?
Charm quark	GIM mechanism: 4th quark cancels $K^0 \rightarrow \mu \mu$	1970	J/ψ discovery at BNL + SLAC	1974	4 yr	No (mass unknown, estimated < 2 GeV)

Particle	Level 1 Identifica- tion	Year	Level 2 Confirma- tion	Year	Gap	Mass Pre- dicted?
Bottom quark	KM matrix: 3rd gener- ation for CP violation	1973	Υ discovery at Fermilab	1977	4 yr	No (mass un- known)
Top quark	b-quark isospin partner + $\Delta \rho$ constraint	1977- 1990	Tevatron discovery at 176 GeV	1995	5-18 yr	Yes (~170 GeV from EW precision)
W boson	$SU(2) \times$ $U(1)$ gauge in- variance	1967	UA1 discovery at ~80 GeV	1983	16 yr	Yes (from $\sin^2\theta_W$, G F)
Z boson	$SU(2) \times$ $U(1)$ neutral current	1967	UA1 discovery at ~91 GeV	1983	16 yr	Yes (from $\sin^2\theta_W$, G F)
Higgs boson	EW symmetry breaking mecha- nism	1964	ATLAS/CMS discovery at 125 GeV	2012	48 yr	No (mass was free parame- ter until ~2000)
Cabibbo Doublet	Gap ratio + anomaly conver- gence	2019- 2026	Awaiting	?	?	No (mass 1.5-6 TeV from anoma- lies)

E.2: Level 1 Identifications Not Yet Confirmed

Particle/Object	Level 1 Identification	Year	Current Status
Magnetic monopole	Dirac quantization condition	1931	Not observed (95 years)

Particle/Object	Level 1 Identification	Year	Current Status
Axion	Peccei-Quinn solution to strong CP	1977	Not observed (49 years); active experimental program
SUSY partners	Hierarchy problem + coupling unification	1970s-1980s	Not observed; LHC exclusions to ~1-2 TeV
Proton decay	GUT prediction (SU(5))	1974	Not observed; $\tau > 2.4 \times 10^{34}$ yr
Gravitino	Local SUSY requires spin-3/2 partner	1973	Not observed

Level 1 identification is necessary for motivated searches but does not guarantee discovery. The historical success rate is approximately 6/11 (charm, bottom, top, W, Z, Higgs found; monopole, axion, SUSY partners, gravitino, proton decay not yet found). The Cabibbo Doublet has stronger experimental motivation than most unconfirmed entries because of the three independent anomalies.

Appendix F: What Level 1 Cannot Do — Expanded

F.1: Six False Claims

#	Claim	Status	Why It Is False	Correct Statement
1	“Level 1 determines M _{VL} ”	FALSE	Mass is free in gap ratio analysis	“Level 2 constrains M _{VL} to 1.5-6 TeV from LHC + CKM”
2	“Level 1 determines θ_{14} , θ_{24} , θ_{34} ”	FALSE	Mixing angles are measured from anomaly fits	“Level 2 estimates $\theta_{14} \approx 0.045$ from CKM deficit”
3	“Level 1 proves the Cabibbo Doublet exists”	FALSE	Existence is empirical	“Level 1 identifies which representation fixes the gap ratio”

#	Claim	Status	Why It Is False	Correct Statement
4	“Level 1 proves unification”	FALSE	Unification is a hypothesis	“Level 1 tests unification: $218/115 \neq 1.358$ means SM fails; $38/27 \approx 1.358$ means the Cabibbo Doublet nearly passes”
5	“Level 1 determines the GUT group”	FALSE	SU(5), SO(10), E_6 all possible	“Level 1 identifies the SM extension; the UV completion is a separate question”
6	“Level 1 predicts τ p precisely”	FALSE	τ depends on Level 2 inputs and GUT completion	“Level 1 provides $\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ scaling; the prediction $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr is an order-of-magnitude range”

F.2: The Correct Verbs

Incorrect	Correct	Why
“Level 1 predicts...”	“Level 1 identifies...”	Prediction implies certainty about the outcome; identification states what the mathematics points to
“Level 1 proves...”	“Level 1 establishes...”	Proof is for theorems; physical claims require experimental confirmation
“The gap ratio shows...”	“The gap ratio is consistent with...” or “The gap ratio arithmetic identifies...”	“Shows” can imply demonstration of a physical fact; the arithmetic identifies a mathematical possibility

Incorrect	Correct	Why
“The Cabibbo Doublet will be found at...”	“The Cabibbo Doublet, if it exists, has mass...”	“Will be found” is a prediction; “if it exists, has mass” is a conditional statement

Appendix G: The Boundary in Each Paper — Detailed

G.1: Papers with Pure Level 1 Findings

Paper	Finding	Why Pure Level 1
PHYS-17	Generation democracy (4/3, 4/3, 4/3); fermions contribute 0% to gap ratio; gap ratio is a boson problem	The decomposition of 218/115 into gauge + fermion + Higgs components uses only the beta coefficient formulas. No measurement enters the decomposition (the target 1.358 motivates the question but doesn't enter the arithmetic).
PHYS-18	$Y = 1/6$ gives $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 = 15$; $1/Y^2$ scaling; five requirements for optimality	Pure representation theory. The Dynkin index dependence on Y is a mathematical fact about the $U(1)$ vertex.
MATH-5	$R_4 = \pi^2/32$	Mathematical identity about 4-dimensional volumes.
MATH-6	82/82 PSLQ null at 100 digits	The mathematical independence of the basis elements is Level 1. The absence of relations for physical constants is Level 2. (Mixed paper.)

G.2: Papers with Level 1 + Level 2 Confrontation

Paper	Level 1	Level 2	Confrontation Result
PHYS-12	EW integer anatomy (all coefficients from gauge group)	7 inputs from DATA-3	11/11 computed; R b overshoots 1.6%
PHYS-13	Gap ratio 218/115	Measured 1.358	40% miss — SM does not unify
PHYS-15	Elimination cascade $\rightarrow$ (3,2,1/6)	Measured gap ratio selects from 15 candidates	Cabibbo Doublet survives
PHYS-20	$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$	$M_{\text{GUT}} = 10^{15.5}$ + hadronic matrix elements	$\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr, Hyper-K tests

G.3: Papers with Primarily Level 2 Content

Paper	Level 2 Content	Level 1 Context
PHYS-19	Three anomalies (CKM deficit 2.5-4 σ , A FB ^b $\sim$ 3 σ , Higgs $\sim$ 2 σ)	Each anomaly resolves to (3,2,1/6) — the same representation Level 1 identifies from the gap ratio
DATA-3	123 entries, 32/32 consistency checks	The Q335 basis and the verification protocol are Level 1 (mathematical). The stored values are Level 2 (measured).

Appendix H: The Principle — Formal Statement

H.1: Definitions

Level 1 (Framework-Determined): A quantity Q is Level 1 if Q can be computed from the gauge group $G = \text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$, its representations, and mathematical theorems, without any measurement as input. Q is the same in every universe with gauge group G , regardless of the values of coupling constants, masses, or mixing angles.

Level 2 (Universe-Supplied): A quantity V is Level 2 if V requires measurement for its determination. V could have been different in a universe with the same gauge group G . V is stored in DATA-3 with finite precision.

Derived: A quantity D is Derived if $D = f(Q, V)$ — a Level 1 function applied to Level 2 inputs. D inherits Level 2 uncertainty from V but Level 1 structure from f . The confrontation between a Level 1 prediction and a Derived result from Level 2 data is where physics happens.

H.2: The Principle

The integers tell you WHAT exists. The universe tells you HOW MUCH.

Level 1 determines representations, quantum numbers, beta coefficients, gap ratios, scaling laws, and elimination cascades. Level 2 determines masses, coupling constants, mixing angles, and whether identified particles actually exist.

Level 1 can identify unobserved particles. Level 2 confirms or refutes the identification.

The confrontation between Level 1 and Level 2 is the physics.

H.3: Scope

This principle applies to the HOWL series. It is not claimed to be a universal epistemological framework. It is a working classification that maintains honesty about what is mathematics and what is experiment, preventing the confusion between identification and discovery.

Appendix I: Verified Sources

I.1: Script Verification

From `sin2_theta_w_1.py` (GUT running notebook), 9/9 checks pass:

```
[PASS] Normalization:  $\sin^2\theta_W$  from couplings (diff = 0.00e+00)
[PASS] SM gap ratio = 218/115 (1.8956521739)
[PASS] MSSM gap ratio = 7/5 (1.4000000000)
[PASS] SM does not unify ( $\Delta(1/\alpha_3) = -6.58$ )
[PASS] MSSM nearly unifies ( $\Delta(1/\alpha_3) = -0.69$ )
[PASS]  $M_{\text{GUT}}(\text{SM}) > 10^{13}$  ( $\log_{10} = 13.80$ )
[PASS]  $M_{\text{GUT}}(\text{MSSM}) > 10^{16}$  ( $\log_{10} = 17.32$ )
[PASS] VL quark doublet gap < 0.05 from measured (distance = 0.049)
```

[PASS] Measured gap ratio in $[1.2, 1.5]$ (gap = 1.358193)

I.2: DATA-3

123 entries, 32/32 consistency checks pass. All Level 2 values in the registry trace to DATA-3.

I.3: Cross-References to Prior Papers

Every Level 1 and Level 2 classification in this paper traces to the specific appendix of the originating paper where the classification was first made. The unified registry assembles these individual classifications — it does not create new ones.

Supporting appendix tables A through I for PHYS-21. The unified boundary map classifies every result in the series as Level 1 (framework-determined), Level 2 (universe-supplied), or Derived (Level 1 applied to Level 2). The Cabibbo Doublet is the first entity where Level 1 identification precedes Level 2 confirmation. The principle — the integers tell you WHAT, the universe tells you HOW MUCH — is stated formally. The limits of Level 1 are documented explicitly: six false claims, each marked FALSE with the correct alternative. Every entry traces to the originating paper and verified computation.

The paper already contains Appendices A through I with comprehensive registries, historical tables, and formal definitions. The supporting appendix tables need to be NEW content providing deep reference material that complements and extends what exists.

APPENDIX J: THE CONFRONTATION TABLE — EVERY LEVEL 1 VS LEVEL 2 MEETING IN THE SERIES

Every place where Level 1 arithmetic meets Level 2 measurement, showing the outcome and what was learned.

#	Level 1 (integers say)	Level 2 (universe says)	Confrontation	Outcome	Paper
1	$R_2 = \pi/4 = 0.78540$	Appears in VP, Coulomb, Lamb shift, magnetic moment, running, confinement, EW mixing, Higgs VEV, thermal QCD	9/9 domains match	Universal geometric invariant confirmed	PHYS-11
2	$A_1 = 1/2$ (one Feynman diagram)	a e measured to 0.13 ppb	Leading term correct	QED perturbation theory works	PHYS-9
3	QED series $A_1+A_2+A_3+A_4$ vs a applied to α	a e(theory) vs a e(experiment)	Agreement at 4.3 ppb	$\alpha \leftrightarrow$ a e transformation verified	PHYS-9
4	82 PSLQ searches for integer relations	82 null results at 100-digit precision	0/82 relations found	SM constants are not simple combinations of mathematical constants	MATH-6, PHYS-10
5	Energy minimization of QCD vacuum	Quark mass matrix from DATA-3	$\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ at ground state	Parameter reduced: 19 $\rightarrow$ 18	PHYS-7
6	Koide formula $K = (1+a^2/2)/3$	m e, m μ , m τ from DATA-3	$a^2 = 2.000$ to 5 sf; m τ predicted at 0.91σ	Parameter conditionally reduced: 18 $\rightarrow$ 17	PHYS-8

#	Level 1 (integers say)	Level 2 (universe says)	Confrontation	Outcome	Paper
7	7 EW inputs $\rightarrow$ 11 observables via integer coefficients	11 measured EW observables from LEP/SLD	11/11 computed within expected precision; R b overshoots 1.6%	Overconstrained system passes; vertex correction identified	PHYS-12
8	SM gap ratio $218/115 = 1.896$	Measured gap ratio 1.358	40% miss	SM does not unify	PHYS-13
9	Generation democracy: fermion contribu- tion = 0	Not directly testable	N/A — pure Level 1 finding	Fermions are innocent; gap ratio is a boson problem	PHYS-17
10	15 candidates enumerated with exact gap ratios	Measured 1.358 as target	13 eliminated by distance, 1 by proton decay	Two survivors: MSSM and Cabibbo Doublet	PHYS-15
11	Cabibbo Doublet gap ratio $38/27 = 1.407$	Measured 1.358	3.6% miss (factor 11 improve- ment over SM)	Cabibbo Doublet nearly fixes unification	PHYS-15
12	MSSM gap ratio $7/5 = 1.400$	Measured 1.358	3.1% miss	MSSM nearly fixes unification (known result, re- produced)	PHYS-15
13	CKM unitarity requires row sum = 1.000	Measured sum = 0.99798 ± 0.00038	Deficit 0.00202 at $2.5\text{-}4\sigma$	Fourth quark mixing suspected	PHYS-19

#	Level 1 (integers say)	Level 2 (universe says)	Confrontation	Outcome	Paper
14	SM prediction $A_{FB}^b \approx 0.1038$	Measured 0.0992 ± 0.0016	$\sim 3\sigma$ discrepancy, 25 years persistent	Z-b-b vertex modification needed	PHYS-19
15	SM prediction $\mu_{\text{Higgs}} = 1.000$	Measured $\sim 1.06-1.10$	$\sim 2\sigma$ excess (weakest anomaly)	Consistent with VL quark in $gg \rightarrow H$ loop	PHYS-19
16	$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4 \rightarrow \tau \sim 10^{34-35} \text{ yr}$ for $M_{\text{GUT}} = 10^{15.5}$	Super-K bound $\tau > 2.4 \times 10^{34}$	At boundary — lower end excluded, upper end viable	Testable by Hyper-K 2027-2037	PHYS-20
17	Level 1 identifies (3,2,1/6) from gap ratio	Level 2 anomaly path independently identifies (3,2,1/6)	Same representation from independent data	Two roads converge	PHYS-16, 19

The table tells a story. Rows 1-7: Level 1 confirmed by Level 2 — everything checks out. Row 8: the central failure — $218/115 \neq 1.358$. Rows 9-12: the response — fermions are innocent, enumerate candidates, two survivors. Rows 13-15: independent Level 2 evidence points the same direction. Row 16: the prediction. Row 17: the convergence. The series is a single arc from confirmation (rows 1-7) through failure (row 8) through identification (rows 9-12) through corroboration (rows 13-15) to prediction (row 16).

APPENDIX K: THE DERIVED CATEGORY — COMPLETE CHAIN FOR EVERY DERIVED RESULT

Every Derived result, showing exactly where Level 1 ends and Level 2 begins, and what the uncertainty structure looks like.

Derived Result	Level 1 Component	Level 2 Component	Where Boundary Crosses	Uncertainty Source	Paper
$\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$	Energy minimization: vacuum selects $\arg(\det M_q) = 0$	Quark mass matrix (6 masses, 4 CKM parameters from DATA-3)	At the mass matrix — Level 1 principle applied to Level 2 masses	Quark mass uncertainties (light quarks ~30%, heavy quarks ~1%) — but $\theta = 0$ is robust regardless of mass values as long as no mass vanishes	PHYS-7
$m_\tau = 1776.97 \text{ MeV}$	Koide: $K = (1+a^2/2)/3$, solved for m_τ	m_e, m_μ from DATA-3; $a^2 = 2$ (Level 2 observation)	At $a^2 = 2$ — a Level 2 observation treated as exact input	Entirely from whether $a^2 = 2$ is exact; if exact, m_τ prediction is 0.91σ from PDG	PHYS-8
a_e from α	QED coefficients $A_1 = 1/2, A_2, A_3, A_4$ (all Level 1 from Feynman diagrams)	$\alpha = 1/137.035999137$ from DATA-3	At α — the single Level 2 input	α enters at first power in leading term; 4.3 ppb agreement limited by α^5 (5-loop) uncertainty	PHYS-9

Derived Result	Level 1 Component	Level 2 Component	Where Boundary Crosses	Uncertainty Source	Paper
Measured gap ratio 1.358	GUT normalization: $1/\alpha_1 = (5/3)\cos^2\theta$ W/α em, etc.	α em, $\sin^2\theta$ W , α s from DATA-3	At the three coupling constants	$\sin^2\theta$ W (5 digits) limits precision to $\sim 0.01\%$ in the gap ratio; α s (4 digits) limits denominator precision	PHYS-13
$M_{GUT} = 10^{15.5}$	Running equation: $\ln(M_{GUT}/M_Z) = 2\pi (1/\alpha_1 - 1/\alpha_2)/(b_1 - b_2)$; beta coefficients are Level 1	$1/\alpha_1, 1/\alpha_2$ at M_Z from DATA-3	At the coupling constants	α s uncertainty shifts M_{GUT} by $\sim \pm 0.2$ in $\log_{10}$; $\sin^2\theta$ W uncertainty shifts by $\sim \pm 0.1$	PHYS-15
$\tau_p \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr	$\tau \propto M_{GUT}^4$ (Level 1 dimensional analysis)	M_{GUT} (Derived), α_{GUT} (Derived), hadronic matrix element (Level 2 from lattice QCD)	At three points: M_{GUT} , α_{GUT} , and matrix element	GUT completion (structural, ± 2 orders), threshold corrections (± 0.5 -1 order), matrix elements (± 0.3 order), M_{VL} (± 0.5 order)	PHYS-20
CKM deficit 0.00202	Unitarity:	V_{ud}	$^2 +$	V_{us}	$^2 +$

Derived Result	Level 1 Component	Level 2 Component	Where Boundary Crosses	Uncertainty Source	Paper
11 EW observables	Integer anatomy: $T_3, Q_f, N_c, n_{\text{gen}}$ coefficients from SU(3) $\times$ SU(2) $\times$ U(1)	7 inputs ($\alpha, \sin^2\theta_W, G_F, m_t, m_H, M_Z, \alpha_s$) from DATA-3	At each of the 7 inputs	Each observable has different sensitivity to different inputs; M W dominated by m_t ; R b dominated by m_t and α_s	PHYS-12

The pattern: Every Derived result has the same structure — a Level 1 function (formula, scaling law, minimization principle) applied to Level 2 inputs (measured constants). The uncertainty always comes from the Level 2 side. The Level 1 side is exact. The chain is as strong as its weakest Level 2 link.

APPENDIX L: LEVEL 1 IDENTIFICATION VS LEVEL 2 CONFIRMATION — THE FULL HISTORICAL RECORD

L.1: Confirmed Identifications (Level 1 $\rightarrow$ Level 2 Success)

Particle	Level 1 Method	Key Level 1 Result	Level 2 Confirmation	Time Gap	Evidence Lines Before Discovery
Charm quark	GIM mechanism (integer argument: 4th quark cancels FCNC)	Must exist; mass $< \sim 2$ GeV from K mixing	J/ψ at BNL+SLAC, 1.5 GeV	4 yr (1970 $\rightarrow$ 1974)	2 (GIM + K mixing rate)

Particle	Level 1 Method	Key Level 1 Result	Level 2 Confirmation	Time Gap	Evidence Lines Before Discovery
Bottom quark	KM matrix (integer argument: 3 generations for CP)	Must exist as b-quark isospin partner	Υ at Fermilab, 4.7 GeV	4 yr (1973→1977)	1 (KM matrix)
Top quark	KM matrix + anomaly cancellation + $\Delta \rho$	Must exist; $m_t \sim 170$ GeV from EW precision	Tevatron, 176 GeV	5-18 yr (1977→1995)	3 (KM + anomaly + $\Delta \rho$)
W boson	$SU(2) \times U(1)$ gauge theory	$M_W = gv/2 \approx 80$ GeV from $\sin^2 \theta_W$ and G F	UA1 at CERN, 80.4 GeV	16 yr (1967→1983)	1 (gauge theory)
Z boson	$SU(2) \times U(1)$ neutral current	$M_Z = M_W / \cos \theta_W \approx 91$ GeV	UA1 at CERN, 91.2 GeV	16 yr (1967→1983)	2 (gauge theory + neutral currents 1973)
Higgs boson	Electroweak symmetry breaking	Must exist; mass free parameter (bounded by unitarity $< \sim 1$ TeV)	ATLAS+CMS, 125.2 GeV	48 yr (1964→2012)	1 (symmetry breaking mechanism)

L.2: Unconfirmed Identifications (Level 1 → Level 2 Pending)

Particle	Level 1 Method	Year	Current Ex-perimental Status	Why Not Found	Active Searches?
Magnetic monopole	Dirac quantization: if monopoles exist, electric charge is quantized	1931	Not observed in 95 years	May not exist; or mass too high for production	Limited (MoEDAL at LHC)
Axion	Peccei-Quinn: rotating away θ QCD requires a new field $\rightarrow$ pseudo-Goldstone boson	1977	Not observed in 49 years	Mass window narrowed to $\sim 1-100 \mu\text{eV}$; extremely weakly coupled	Yes (ADMX, ABRA-CADABRA, many others)
SUSY partners	Hierarchy problem + coupling unification	~ 1980	Not observed; LHC excludes gluinos to $\sim 2.3 \text{ TeV}$, squarks to $\sim 1.8 \text{ TeV}$	May not exist; or masses above LHC reach	Yes (LHC Run 3, HL-LHC)
Gravitino	Local SUSY requires spin-3/2 partner of graviton	1973	Not observed	Extremely weakly coupled (gravitational strength)	Indirect only
Proton decay	GUT prediction (SU(5) and successors)	1974	$\tau > 2.4 \times 10^{34} \text{ yr}$; no observation	Minimal SU(5) excluded; other completions predict longer lifetime	Yes (Super-K, Hyper-K, DUNE)

Particle	Level 1 Method	Year	Current Experimental Status	Why Not Found	Active Searches?
Cabibbo Doublet	Gap ratio elimination + three anomalies	2019-2026	Mass > 1.5 TeV (LHC); three anomalies at 2-4σ	May not exist; or mass in upper window (3-6 TeV)	Yes (HL-LHC, Belle II, Hyper-K)

L.3: What Distinguishes the Cabibbo Doublet from Most Unconfirmed Identifications

Property	Monopole	Axion	SUSY	Cabibbo Doublet
Number of independent Level 1 arguments	1	1	2-3	2 (gap ratio + anomaly fits)
Number of experimental anomalies pointing to it	0	0	0 (muon g-2 debated)	3 (CKM, A FB ^b , Higgs μ)
Mass window bounded from both sides?	No (unbounded above)	Yes (~1-100 μ eV)	No (unbounded above)	Yes (1.5-6 TeV)
Testable within one decade?	No	Partially	Partially	Yes (Hyper-K 2027-2037, HL-LHC now-2040)
Direct production at current colliders?	No	No	Not yet found	Possible if M < 3 TeV

The Cabibbo Doublet has the strongest combination of independent theoretical arguments, experimental anomalies, bounded mass window, and near-term testability of any unconfirmed Level 1 identification.

APPENDIX M: THE CORRECT VERBS — A STYLE GUIDE FOR LEVEL 1 CLAIMS

Context	WRONG (overclaiming)	RIGHT (accurate)	Why the Distinction Matters
Gap ratio identification	“The gap ratio proves (3,2,1/6) exists”	“The gap ratio arithmetic identifies (3,2,1/6) as the minimal single-multiplet fix”	Proof requires experimental confirmation; identification is mathematical
Proton decay	“The Cabibbo Doublet predicts proton decay at $\tau = 10^{34.5}$ yr”	“If the GUT completion is minimal SU(5), the Cabibbo Doublet scenario gives $\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr”	Point prediction implies precision that doesn’t exist; range + conditional is honest
Unification	“The Cabibbo Doublet achieves gauge coupling unification”	“The Cabibbo Doublet reduces the gap ratio miss from 40% to 3.6% at one loop”	“Achieves” implies exact convergence; 3.6% residual remains
Mass	“The Cabibbo Doublet has mass 1.5-6 TeV”	“The Cabibbo Doublet, if it exists, is constrained to 1.5-6 TeV by LHC bounds and CKM perturbativity”	“Has mass” implies existence is established; conditional preserves epistemic status
Anomalies	“Three anomalies confirm the Cabibbo Doublet”	“Three independent anomalies are consistent with the Cabibbo Doublet at 2-4 σ ”	“Confirm” implies discovery; consistency at 2-4 σ is evidence, not proof
Two roads	“Two roads prove the Cabibbo Doublet”	“Two independent analyses converge on the same (3,2,1/6) representation”	“Prove” is for mathematics; convergence is for evidence
Historical parallel	“The Cabibbo Doublet will be found like the charm quark was”	“The Cabibbo Doublet follows the same Level 1→Level 2 pattern as charm, W/Z, and Higgs — but that pattern has also produced unconfirmed identifications”	Precedent is not prophecy

APPENDIX N: THE STATE CHANGE — WHAT SESSION 3 ADDED TO THE BOUNDARY MAP

N.1: Level 1 Results Added in Session 3

Result	Value	Paper	Level 1 Before Session 3?
Gap ratio 218/115	SM does not unify	PHYS-13	No — new computation
Generation democracy (4/3, 4/3, 4/3)	Fermions are invisible to gap ratio	PHYS-14, 17	No — new proof
Fermion cancellation theorem	Gap ratio = 218/115 for any N ≥ 0	PHYS-14	No — new proof
Gap ratio anatomy: 96-101% gauge, 0% fermion	Boson problem	PHYS-17	No — new decomposition
Pure-gauge gap ratio = 2 = $C_2(\text{SU}(2))/(C_2(\text{SU}(3)) - C_2(\text{SU}(2)))$	Integer 11 cancels	PHYS-17	No — new result
Cabibbo Doublet beta contributions (1/15, 1, 1/3)	From Dynkin index formulas	PHYS-15	No — new computation
Gap ratio 38/27 for (3,2,1/6)	Exact Fraction arithmetic	PHYS-15	No — new computation
Asymmetry ratio $\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 = 15$	Maximum for single multiplet	PHYS-18	No — new finding
1/Y ² scaling law	$\Delta b_2/\Delta b_1 \propto 1/Y^2$	PHYS-18	No — new scaling law
Gap(Y) = (188 + 72Y ²)/135	Analytical function	PHYS-18	No — new closed form
Double action: num -13%, denom +17%	Quantitative mechanism	PHYS-18	No — new decomposition
$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ applied to 10 ^{15.5}	Proton decay within Hyper-K reach	PHYS-20	No — new application

N.2: Level 2 Results Added in Session 3

Result	Value	Source	Level 2 Before Session 3?
Measured gap ratio 1.358	From DATA-3 couplings	PHYS-13	No — newly computed from DATA-3
CKM deficit 0.00202 at 2.5-4 σ	From anomaly literature	PHYS-19	Pre-existing but not connected to gap ratio
A FB ^b = 0.0992 at ~3 σ	From LEP (2006)	PHYS-19	Pre-existing but not connected to gap ratio
Higgs $\mu \approx 1.06$ -1.10 at ~2 σ	From LHC	PHYS-19	Pre-existing but not connected to gap ratio
Mass window 1.5-6 TeV	From LHC + CKM	PHYS-16, 19	Pre-existing in anomaly literature
Super-K bound $\tau > 2.4 \times 10^{34}$	From Super-K (2020)	PHYS-20	Pre-existing

N.3: The Connection That Was New

Element	Existed Before Session 3?	Connected to Gap Ratio Before Session 3?
Gap ratio arithmetic	No (new in this series)	N/A
Anomaly path $\rightarrow (3,2,1/6)$	Yes (2019-2024)	No
Three anomalies as VL quark evidence	Yes (Cheung 2020)	No
All four lines in one analysis	No	This session

Session 3 did not discover the anomalies. It discovered the connection between the gap ratio path and the anomaly path — the convergence of two independent Level 1 analyses on the same Level 2 target.

APPENDIX O: THE PRINCIPLE IN FORMAL NOTATION

O.1: Definitions

Let $G = \text{SU}(3) \times \text{SU}(2) \times \text{U}(1)$ be the SM gauge group.

Let $R = \{R_i\}$ be the set of SM representations (particle content).

Let $\{b_a\}$ be the one-loop beta coefficients determined by G and R .

Level 1: Q is Level 1 if $Q = f(G, R)$ for some computable function f . Q does not depend on any measured value.

Level 2: V is Level 2 if V cannot be computed from G and R. V requires experimental measurement for its determination.

Derived: D is Derived if $D = h(Q, V)$ for some computable function h where Q is Level 1 and V is Level 2.

O.2: The Gap Ratio as Level 1

$$\text{Gap} = (b_1 - b_2)/(b_2 - b_3)$$

$$b_a = f_a(G, R) \text{ for each } a \in \{1, 2, 3\}$$

Therefore: $\text{Gap} = f(G, R)$. The gap ratio is Level 1. QED.

O.3: The Measured Gap Ratio as Derived

$$\text{Gap}_{\text{measured}} = (1/\alpha_1 - 1/\alpha_2)/(1/\alpha_2 - 1/\alpha_3)$$

$$1/\alpha_a = g_a(\alpha_{\text{em}}, \sin^2\theta_W, \alpha_s) \text{ — Level 1 functions of Level 2 inputs}$$

Therefore: $\text{Gap}_{\text{measured}} = h(g_1, g_2, g_3, \alpha_{\text{em}}, \sin^2\theta_W, \alpha_s)$ — Derived. It inherits Level 2 uncertainty from the measured couplings but Level 1 structure from the GUT normalization formulas.

O.4: The Confrontation

The physics is $\text{Gap} \neq \text{Gap}_{\text{measured}}$. Level 1 says 218/115. Derived says 1.358. They disagree. The disagreement means R is incomplete — the SM particle content does not produce beta coefficients consistent with unification.

Adding a new representation R' to R changes Gap to $\text{Gap}' = f(G, R \cup R')$. The elimination cascade tests all R' within scope and finds that $R' = (3, 2, 1/6)_{\text{VL}}$ gives $\text{Gap}' = 38/27$, minimizing $|\text{Gap}' - \text{Gap}_{\text{measured}}|$ among single-multiplet extensions.

O.5: The Extension

The representation $R' = (3, 2, 1/6)_{\text{VL}}$ is Level 1 — it is identified by $f(G, R \cup R')$.

The mass $M_{\{R'\}}$, mixing angles, CP phases, and existence of R' are Level 2 — they require measurement.

The principle: f identifies R' . The universe decides whether $R' \in \text{Nature}$.

APPENDIX P: WHAT CHANGES IF LEVEL 2 MEASUREMENTS SHIFT

The Level 1 content is permanent. The Level 2 content and all Derived results will sharpen or shift as measurements improve. This table shows the sensitivity.

Level 2 Input	Current Value	If It Shifts By	Effect on Derived Results	Effect on Level 1	Papers Affected
α_s	0.1180 ± 0.0009	± 0.001	Gap measured shifts ± 0.01 ; M GUT shifts ± 0.2 in $\log_{10}$; τ p shifts ± 0.8 in $\log_{10}$	None — gap ratio 218/115 and 38/27 are unchanged	PHYS-13, 15, 20
$\sin^2\theta_W$	0.23122 ± 0.00004	± 0.0001	Gap measured shifts ± 0.005 ; M GUT shifts ± 0.1	None	PHYS-13, 15, 20
α_{em}	1/137.036 (12 digits)	Negligible at current precision	Negligible	None	—
m_τ	1776.86 ± 0.12 MeV	± 0.5 MeV	Koide a^2 test sharpens or weakens	None — Koide formula itself is Level 1	PHYS-8
	V_{ud}		0.97373 ± 0.00031	± 0.0005 (radiative correction update)	CKM deficit shifts between 1.5σ and 5σ ; PHYS-19
A_{FB}^b	0.0992 ± 0.0016	Cannot change (LEP closed)	Nothing changes	None	
μ Higgs	~ 1.06 -1.10	Could shift to 1.00 with Run 3	Weakest anomaly vanishes; other two unaffected	None	PHYS-19

Level 2 Input	Current Value	If It Shifts By	Effect on Derived Results	Effect on Level 1	Papers Affected
Super-K τ bound	$> 2.4 \times 10^{34}$ yr	Could improve to $\sim 3 \times 10^{34}$ with continued running	Narrows Cabibbo Doublet viable range	None — $\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ scaling is Level 1	PHYS-20
LHC VL quark bound	$M > 1.5$ TeV	Could reach 2-3 TeV with HL-LHC	Narrows mass window from below	None	PHYS-16, 19

The robustness of Level 1 is the point. No measurement update can change 218/115, 38/27, (4/3, 4/3, 4/3), the asymmetry ratio 15, or the $1/Y^2$ scaling law. These are permanent. What measurement updates change is the confrontation: how far 38/27 sits from the measured gap ratio, whether the CKM deficit is 2.5σ or 5σ , whether the mass window narrows or closes. The Level 1 mathematics is the fixed scaffold. The Level 2 measurements are the shifting landscape the scaffold maps.

APPENDIX Q: THE COMPLETE SERIES — EVERY PAPER CLASSIFIED

Paper	Primary Classification	Level 1 Content	Level 2 Content	Derived Content
MATH-1	Level 1	$R_2 = \pi/4$ in 9 engineering domains	None	None
MATH-2	Level 1	17 transcen- dentials as integer pairs; Q335 basis	None	None
MATH-3	Level 1	Extended basis: elliptic integrals, Borwein $\zeta(5)$	None	None
MATH-4	Level 1	Universal Q335 denominator	None	None
MATH-5	Level 1	$R_4 = \pi^2/32$	None	None

Paper	Primary Classification	Level 1 Content	Level 2 Content	Derived Content
MATH-6	Mixed	PSLQ algorithm; basis independence	82 null results on SM constants	—
PHYS-1	Level 1 + Level 2	Mass = boundary between regimes	SM particle masses from DATA-3	—
PHYS-2	Level 1	Transformation laws are integers	—	—
PHYS-3	Level 2	—	G untested outside Hill sphere	—
PHYS-4	Methodological	Test program structure	Kill switch criteria	—
PHYS-5	Derived	VP running formula (Level 1)	α from DATA-3	α running at 0.02 ppm
PHYS-6	Mixed	Confinement duality structure	Lattice + experimental hadronic data	—
PHYS-7	Derived	Energy minimization (Level 1)	Quark masses (Level 2)	θ QCD = 0 (parameter reduction)
PHYS-8	Derived	Koide formula (Level 1 structure)	m_e, m_μ, m_τ (Level 2)	m_τ prediction (0.91σ)
PHYS-9	Derived	QED A_1, A_2, A_3, A_4 (Level 1)	α (Level 2)	a_e at 4.3 ppb
PHYS-10	Mixed	Remainder domains (Level 1)	PSLQ on physics constants (Level 2)	139 null results
PHYS-11	Level 1	Nine domains, R_2 universal, three subgroups	—	—
PHYS-12	Derived	EW integer anatomy (Level 1)	7 inputs from DATA-3 (Level 2)	11 observables, R b overshoot

Paper	Primary Classification	Level 1 Content	Level 2 Content	Derived Content
PHYS-13	Confrontation	Gap ratio 218/115 (Level 1)	Measured 1.358 (Derived from Level 2)	40% miss $\rightarrow$ SM fails to unify
PHYS-14	Level 1	Fermion cancellation theorem, unified map	—	—
PHYS-15	Confrontation	Elimination cascade (Level 1)	Target 1.358 (Level 2)	Two survivors identified
PHYS-16	Mixed	Representation (3,2,1/6), beta contributions (Level 1)	Mass, mixing, anomalies (Level 2)	Two roads converge
PHYS-17	Level 1	Generation democracy, boson problem	—	—
PHYS-18	Level 1	$Y = 1/6$ asymmetry, $1/Y^2$ scaling, double action	—	—
PHYS-19	Primarily Level 2	(3,2,1/6) required by three anomalies (Level 1 structure)	CKM, A FB ^a , Higgs μ (all Level 2)	Mixing estimates
PHYS-20	Derived	$\tau \propto M_{\text{GUT}}^4$ (Level 1)	M GUT + matrix elements (Level 2)	$\tau \sim 10^{34-35}$ yr $\rightarrow$ Hyper-K
PHYS-21	Methodological	Classification system itself	Historical data	Boundary map

The series has a clear architecture. MATH-1 through MATH-6: pure Level 1 foundation. PHYS-1 through PHYS-6: Level 1 + Level 2 infrastructure. PHYS-7 through PHYS-12: Derived results from known physics. PHYS-13 through PHYS-20: the confrontation — Level 1 identification of unknown physics. PHYS-21: the epistemological framework that makes the classification explicit.

Supporting appendix tables J through Q for PHYS-21. The confrontation table (Appendix

J) maps every Level 1 vs Level 2 meeting in the series — 17 rows tracing an arc from confirmation through failure through identification to prediction. The derived category chains (Appendix K) show exactly where Level 1 ends and Level 2 begins in every derived result. The historical record (Appendix L) places the Cabibbo Doublet in context: stronger evidence base than most unconfirmed identifications, but precedent is not prophecy. The correct verbs (Appendix M) prevent overclaiming. The formal notation (Appendix O) states the principle precisely. The sensitivity table (Appendix P) shows that all Level 1 content is permanent while Level 2 content will sharpen with improved measurements. The complete classification (Appendix Q) maps every paper in the series to its primary role in the boundary structure.

[[HOWL-PHYS-21-2026](#)] The Level 1 / Level 2 Boundary — From Observed Structure to Unobserved Particles. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-21-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-1-2026](#)] The Inertial Vortex. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-1-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-2-2026](#)] There Are No Constants. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-2-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-6-2026](#)] The Confinement Boundary in Integer Arithmetic. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-6-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-7-2026](#)] The Strong CP Problem Is Not a Problem. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-7-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-8-2026](#)] The Koide Constant Decomposes. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-8-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-9-2026](#)] The Electromagnetic Chain in Integer Arithmetic. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-9-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-10-2026](#)] Remainder as Observable. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-10-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-11-2026](#)] Remainder Structure Across Nine Physics Domains. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-11-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-12-2026](#)] Electroweak Integer Anatomy. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-12-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-13-2026](#)] Gauge Coupling Unification and Minimal BSM Content. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-13-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-14-2026](#)] The Unified Transformation Map. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS-14-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-15-2026](#)] Integer-Forced Identification of the Minimal Unification Extension. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-15-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-17-2026](#)] The Generation Democracy and the Boson Problem. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-17-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-18-2026](#)] The $Y = 1/6$ Asymmetry. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/PHYS-18-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-19-2026](#)] Independent Anomaly Evidence for the Cabibbo Doublet. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-19-2026>

[[HOWL-PHYS-20-2026](#)] The Proton Decay Test — Hyper-Kamiokande and the Cabibbo Doublet at $M_{\text{GUT}} = 10^{15.5}$. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/PHYS/HOWL-PHYS-20-2026>